UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Municipalities.md + 24_Municipalities.md

Learning cards: 38



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/24_Municipalities.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/24_Municipalities.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = mnemonic · □ = current link. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/24_Municipalities.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Part / Articles	**Part IX-A**, Art **243-P–243-ZG**
Schedule	**Twelfth Schedule — 18 subjects** (Art 243-W)
Enacted / in force	**74th Amendment 1992** → in force **1 June 1993**
Bodies	**Nagar Panchayat · Municipal Council · Municipal Corporation**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 74th Amendment gave **constitutional status** to **urban local bodies (ULBs)** — mirroring the 73rd for villages. Three types of municipality by area size, with directly elected territorial seats, reservations, a 5-year term, and district/metropolitan planning committees.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 The 74th Amendment gave constitutional status to urban local bodies (ULBs) — mirroring the 73rd for villages. Three types of municipality by area size	**Dimension 2** □ "Nagar–Council–Corporation = Transitional–Smaller–Larger" (increasing size).
Dimension 3 □ Schedules: 11th → panchayats (29) · 12th → municipalities (18).	

STATIC THEORY

- □ **"Nagar–Council–Corporation = Transitional–Smaller–Larger"** (increasing size).

- □ **Schedules:** 11th → panchayats (**29**) · 12th → municipalities (**18**).

MEMORY HOOK

"Nagar–Council–Corporation = Transitional–Smaller–Larger" (increasing size). | Schedules: 11th → panchayats (29) · 12th → municipalities (18).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **3 types**: Nagar Panchayat (transitional), Municipal Council (small town), Municipal Corporation (big city).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 □ 3 types: Nagar Panchayat (transitional), Municipal Council (small town), Municipal Corporation (big city).	**Dimension 2** □ All territorial seats are directly elected from wards; state law may also
Dimension 3 provide representation for experts (without voting rights) and specified MPs/MLAs/ committee chairpersons. Wards Committees are required where populat	**Dimension 4** □ Reservation: SC/ST by population + ≥ 1/3 for women.

STATIC THEORY

- □ All **territorial seats** are directly elected from wards; state law may also

- provide representation for experts (without voting rights) and specified MPs/MLAs/ committee chairpersons. **Wards Committees** are required where population ≥3 lakh.

- □ Reservation: SC/ST by population + **≥ 1/3 for women**.

- □ **5-year term**; election within **6 months** of dissolution; min candidate age **21**.

- □ **State Election Commission** conducts polls; **State Finance Commission** reviews finances.

- □ **DPC** (4/5 elected) at district level; **MPC** (2/3 elected) for metropolitan areas.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 3 types: Nagar Panchayat (transitional), Municipal Council (small town), Municipal Corporation (big city).

2. All **territorial seats** are directly elected from wards; state law may also

3. Reservation: SC/ST by population + **≥ 1/3 for women**.

4. 5-year term; election within **6 months** of dissolution; min candidate age **21**.

5. State Election Commission conducts polls; **State Finance Commission** reviews finances.

6. DPC (4/5 elected) at district level; **MPC** (2/3 elected) for metropolitan areas.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **8 types of urban bodies** exist (incl. Cantonment Board — run by the Centre/Defence Ministry).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 8 types of urban bodies exist (incl. Cantonment Board — run by the Centre/Defence Ministry).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ **Municipal finance crisis** & weak devolution (Smart Cities/AMRUT run partly by parastatals, not elected ULBs); **16th Finance Commission** grants to urban bodies keep the debate live.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Purpose: make this Core file independently answer directive-sensitive GS-II questions on the 74th Amendment — the functional and financial empowerment of urban local bodies, the planning-committee weak link, parastatals and municipal leadership — without opening Advanced. Municipal-finance figures are a trap: prefer named, dated, qualitative evidence over invented own-revenue percentages.

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

***2023 · GS-II · Q3** — Demand (neutral rendering): comment on the extent to which States have empowered urban local bodies functionally and financially since the 74th Amendment. Directive: **Comment · 10 marks · 150 words**. **Core routing supersedes the older advanced/24_Municipalities.md pointer for this demand.** **Executable route:** (1) **Thesis** — the **74th Amendment 1992 (Part IX-A)** mandated urban self-government, but functional and financial empowerment was left to State discretion (**Art 243W** and **Art 243X** are enabling), so Indian cities are governed but not self-governed. (2) **Functional gap — Art 243W + Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects)** is may-devolve; core functions (spatial planning, water, transport) are retained by **State parastatals and development authorities**; the **District Planning Committee (Art 243ZD)** and **Metropolitan Planning Committee (Art 243ZE)** — the constitutional planning tier — are the **weakest link**, often un-constituted or powerless. (3) **Financial gap** — **Art 243X** permits own taxes, tolls and fees, but **property tax** is under-exploited, **State Finance Commissions (Art 243Y/243-I)** are delayed, and municipal bonds remain nascent, leaving dependence on tied grants. (4) **Leadership gap** — short/rotational, mostly indirectly elected **mayors** with executive power resting in the State-appointed **Municipal Commissioner**; hence the directly-elected-mayor debate. (5) **Evidence** — **Smart Cities Mission** SPVs and **AMRUT** are run partly through parastatals, bypassing elected councils. (6) **Verdict** — the constitutional design for empowerment exists; States under-deliver, so reform means completing activity mapping of the 18 subjects, empowering DPC/MPC, buoyant own-revenue and an empowered mayor.*

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Functional & financial empowerment	"governed not self-governed", "3 Fs in cities", Comment/Examine	Art 243W/243X enabling → parastatals → DPC/MPC weak link → own-revenue gap → verdict
Constitutional design of ULBs	"74th Amendment features", Describe	Three types (Art 243Q) → composition/reservation/term → SEC/SFC → planning committees
Urban planning fragmentation	"who plans our cities", "MPC", Analyse	Art 243ZD/243ZE mandate → non-constitution → development-authority capture → verdict
Municipal finance	"municipal finance crisis", property tax, bonds, Assess	Art 243X instruments → property-tax under-use → SFC delay → grant dependence
City leadership	"directly elected mayor", Comment	Weak mayor + strong Commissioner → tenure → accountability → reform
Urban missions vs ULBs	"Smart Cities/AMRUT vs elected bodies", Examine	Mission SPVs/parastatals → constitutional ULB role → reconciliation

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 74th Amendment constitutionalised the existence of urban local bodies but left their functional and financial empowerment to the States, so Indian cities are administered by the State and its agencies more than governed by their elected councils.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1
The 74th Amendment constitutionalised the existence of urban local bodies but left their functional and financial empowerment to the States, so Indian

Dimension 2
The weakest link in the 74th Amendment is spatial planning: without empowered District and Metropolitan Planning Committees, elected cities cannot pla

Dimension 3
Municipal finance fails less for want of powers — Art 243X permits property tax, tolls, fees and funds — than for low property-tax effort, delayed Sta

Dimension 4
A city with a one-year rotational mayor and a State-appointed commissioner has representation without executive self-government; the directly-elected-

STATIC THEORY

- The weakest link in the 74th Amendment is spatial planning: without empowered District and Metropolitan Planning Committees, elected cities cannot plan themselves, and development authorities fill the vacuum.

- Municipal finance fails less for want of powers — Art 243X permits property tax, tolls, fees and funds — than for low property-tax effort, delayed State Finance Commissions and untapped municipal-bond markets.

- A city with a one-year rotational mayor and a State-appointed commissioner has representation without executive self-government; the directly-elected-mayor debate is really a debate about where urban executive power should sit.

- Centrally designed urban missions delivering through SPVs and parastatals can build infrastructure while weakening the constitutional claim of elected municipalities to govern.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → functional gap → financial gap → one qualification → verdict	3 units, at least one exact Article
15	Thesis → design on the Articles → planning-committee weak link → finance → leadership → verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → constitutional design → functional/financial/planning empowerment → parastatals → State variation → graded verdict	6–8 units + a "governed vs self-governed" paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Constitutional architecture on the exact Articles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: ULBs are a constitutional institution mirroring the 73rd Amendment. → **Evidence: 74th Amendment 1992**, **Part IX-A (Art 243-P to 243-ZG)**, **Twelfth Schedule** for **Art 243W**; in force **1 June 1993**. → **Significance:** States are constitutionally obliged to adopt the system. → **Caution:** □ in force **1 June 1993**, not 1992; Twelfth Schedule = **18** subjects (not 29).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.4 BANK A — CONSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE ON THE EXACT ARTICLES: RECALL MAP

5.4 Bank A — Constitutional architecture on the exact Articles

V

Dimension 1 Claim: ULBs are a constitutional institution mirroring the 73rd Amendment. → Evidence: 74th Amendment 1992, Part IX-A (Art 243-P to 243-ZG), Twelfth S	**Dimension 2** Claim: Three types of municipality track the degree of urbanisation. → Evidence: Art 243Q — Nagar Panchayat (transitional area), Municipal Council (sm
Dimension 3 Claim: Territorial seats are directly elected with mandatory ward-level bodies in big cities. → Evidence: Art 243R composition (all territorial seats	**Dimension 4** Claim: Reservation, tenure and disqualification mirror panchayats. → Evidence: Art 243T (SC/ST by population, ≥ 1/3 for women, BC optional); Art 243U

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** Three types of municipality track the degree of urbanisation. → **Evidence: Art 243Q — Nagar Panchayat** (transitional area), **Municipal Council** (smaller urban area), **Municipal Corporation** (larger urban area); the Governor classifies areas by population, density, revenue, non-agricultural employment and economic importance, and may specify an **industrial township** where no municipality need be constituted. → **Significance:** a graduated urban-governance ladder. → **Caution:** □ Corporation = **largest**, Nagar Panchayat = transitional — do not invert.

- **Claim:** Territorial seats are directly elected with mandatory ward-level bodies in big cities. → **Evidence: Art 243R** composition (all territorial seats directly elected from wards; specified additional representation permitted); **Art 243S — Wards Committees mandatory where population ≥ 3 lakh**. → **Significance:** intra-city decentralisation for large municipalities. → **Caution:** □ Wards Committees are required only at **≥ 3 lakh**, not in every municipality.

- **Claim:** Reservation, tenure and disqualification mirror panchayats. → **Evidence: Art 243T** (SC/ST by population, **≥ 1/3 for women**, BC optional); **Art 243U** (five-year term, election within six months of dissolution); **Art 243V** (candidate age **21**). → **Significance:** uniform inclusion and tenure floor. → **Caution:** □ age **21**, not 25.

- **Claim:** Independent electoral and fiscal machinery is constitutionally required. → **Evidence: State Election Commission (Art 243ZA)** conducts municipal polls; **State Finance Commission (Art 243Y, the body constituted under Art 243-I)** reviews ULB finances every five years; **Art 243ZG** bars court interference in electoral matters. → **Significance:** insulates urban elections and fiscal review from the executive. → **Caution:** □ the ECI does not run municipal polls — it is the SEC; the *same* SFC serves panchayats and municipalities.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: ULBs are a constitutional institution mirroring the 73rd Amendment. → **Evidence: 74th Amendment 1992**, **Part IX-A (Art 243-P to 243-ZG)**, **Twelfth Schedule** for **Art 243W**; in force **1 June 1993**. → **Significance:** States are constitutionally obliged to adopt the system. → **Caution:** in force **1 June 1993**, not 1992; Twelfth Schedule = **18** subjects (not 29).

2. Claim: Three types of municipality track the degree of urbanisation. → **Evidence: Art 243Q — Nagar Panchayat** (transitional area), **Municipal Council** (smaller urban area), **Municipal Corporation** (larger urban area); the Governor classifies areas by population, density, revenue, non-agricultural employment and economic importance, and may specify an **industrial township** where no municipality need be constituted. → **Significance:** a graduated urban-governance ladder. → **Caution:** Corporation = **largest**, Nagar Panchayat = transitional — do not invert.

3. Claim: Territorial seats are directly elected with mandatory ward-level bodies in big cities. → **Evidence: Art 243R** composition (all territorial seats directly elected from wards; specified additional representation permitted); **Art 243S — Wards Committees mandatory where population ≥ 3 lakh**. → **Significance:** intra-city decentralisation for large municipalities. → **Caution:** Wards Committees are required only at **≥ 3 lakh**, not in every municipality.

4. Claim: Reservation, tenure and disqualification mirror panchayats. → **Evidence: Art 243T** (SC/ST by population, **≥ 1/3 for women**, BC optional); **Art 243U** (five-year term, election within six months of dissolution); **Art 243V** (candidate age **21**). → **Significance:** uniform inclusion and tenure floor. → **Caution:** age **21**, not 25.

5. Claim: Independent electoral and fiscal machinery is constitutionally required. → **Evidence: State Election Commission (Art 243ZA)** conducts municipal polls; **State Finance Commission (Art 243Y, the body constituted under Art 243-I)** reviews ULB finances every five years; **Art 243ZG** bars court interference in electoral matters. → **Significance:** insulates urban elections and fiscal review from the executive. → **Caution:** the ECI does not run municipal polls — it is the SEC; the *same* SFC serves panchayats and municipalities.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Constitutional architecture on the exact Articles

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Functional empowerment and the planning weak link (owns 2023 Q3)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: Functional devolution is enabling, not mandatory. → **Evidence: Art 243W + Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects)** — urban planning, regulation of land use, water supply, public health, urban poverty alleviation, etc. → **Significance:** States decide how much to actually transfer. → **Caution:** □□ most States have not completed "activity mapping", so functions overlap with line departments.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — FUNCTIONAL EMPOWERMENT AND THE PLANNING WEAK LINK (OWNS 2023 Q3): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — Functional empowerment and the planning weak link (owns 2023 Q3)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: Functional devolution is enabling, not mandatory. → Evidence: Art 243W + Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects) — urban planning, regulation of land us	**Dimension 2** Claim: The planning committees are the constitutional heart — and the weakest link. → Evidence: District Planning Committee (Art 243ZD, four-fifths el
Dimension 3 Claim: Development authorities and parastatals capture core urban functions. → Evidence: State urban development authorities, water and sewerage board	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** The planning committees are the constitutional heart — and the weakest link. → **Evidence: District Planning Committee (Art 243ZD, four-fifths elected)** consolidates panchayat + municipal plans; **Metropolitan Planning Committee (Art 243ZE, two-thirds elected)** for metropolitan areas. → **Significance:** they are meant to make elected bodies, not bureaucracies, plan the city. → **Caution:** □□ many States have **not constituted MPCs even for major metros**, or left them powerless; do not assume they function.

- **Claim:** Development authorities and parastatals capture core urban functions. → **Evidence:** State urban development authorities, water and sewerage boards, and Smart Cities SPVs perform planning and service delivery instead of elected councils. → **Significance:** produces "cities governed but not self-governed". → **Caution:** □□ arrangements vary by State; state this as a structural tendency, not a uniform fact.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Functional empowerment and the planning weak link (owns 2023 Q3)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — Financial empowerment (owns 2023 Q3)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: The Constitution enables own-source municipal revenue. → **Evidence: Art 243X** — the State legislature may authorise a municipality to levy taxes, duties, tolls and fees, assign State taxes, give grants-in-aid, and constitute municipal funds. → **Significance:** own revenue is a route to fiscal autonomy. → **Caution:** □ it is *enabling* — the ULB taxes only what the State authorises.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.6 BANK C — FINANCIAL EMPOWERMENT (OWNS 2023 Q3): RECALL MAP

5.6 Bank C — Financial empowerment (owns 2023 Q3)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: The Constitution enables own-source municipal revenue. → Evidence: Art 243X — the State legislature may authorise a municipality to levy taxes,	**Dimension 2** Claim: Property tax is the mainstay but under-exploited. → Evidence: property/house tax, user charges (water, sanitation), tolls, licensing and market
Dimension 3 Claim: Grant dependence persists due to weak fiscal machinery. → Evidence: delayed SFCs (Art 243Y/243-I); tied 15th/16th Finance Commission urban gran	

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** Property tax is the mainstay but under-exploited. → **Evidence:** property/house tax, user charges (water, sanitation), tolls, licensing and market fees; **municipal bonds** as a capital-market route. → **Significance:** buoyant own-revenue reduces grant dependence and improves accountability. → **Caution:** □ do **not** quote a municipal own-revenue share of GDP or a collection-efficiency percentage without a named, dated official source.

- **Claim:** Grant dependence persists due to weak fiscal machinery. → **Evidence:** delayed **SFCs (Art 243Y/243-I)**; tied **15th/16th Finance Commission** urban grants. → **Significance:** explains why Art 243X powers stay under-used. → **Caution:** □□ qualitative; avoid inventing figures.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: The Constitution enables own-source municipal revenue. → **Evidence: Art 243X** — the State legislature may authorise a municipality to levy taxes, duties, tolls and fees, assign State taxes, give grants-in-aid, and constitute municipal funds. → **Significance:** own revenue is a route to fiscal autonomy. → **Caution:** it is *enabling* — the ULB taxes only what the State authorises.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — Financial empowerment (owns 2023 Q3)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Municipal leadership and personnel

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: The elected mayor is usually weak; executive power sits with the appointed commissioner. → **Evidence:** in many States mayors serve short/rotational terms and are indirectly elected, while the State-appointed **Municipal Commissioner (an IAS/State-service officer)** wields executive authority. → **Significance:** representation without an empowered executive head. → **Caution:** □□ tenure and election mode vary by State — do not assert a single national rule.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** The directly-elected-mayor model is contested. → **Evidence:** several States have experimented with directly elected mayors and some have reverted to indirect election. → **Significance:** the debate is about locating urban executive power in an accountable elected office. → **Caution:** □□ do not attribute a current model to a named State without verifying its present status.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Municipal leadership and personnel

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Why States under-devolve:** urban land, water and planning are lucrative and politically salient, so States retain them through development authorities and boards while formally constituting municipalities.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.8 MECHANISM, INSTITUTIONAL INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

V

Dimension 1 □□ Why States under-devolve: urban land, water and planning are lucrative and politically salient, so States retain them through development authoriti	**Dimension 2** □□ Planning vacuum: where MPC/DPC (Art 243ZE/243ZD) are unformed, statutory planning defaults to parastatals, so the elected city cannot control its o
Dimension 3 □□ Fiscal accountability: property tax (Art 243X) ties citizens' payments to service demands; grant dependence orients municipalities upward to the gr	**Dimension 4** □□ Executive-representative split: a strong appointed commissioner plus a weak mayor concentrates accountability in the State cadre, not the ballot.

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Planning vacuum:** where MPC/DPC (Art 243ZE/243ZD) are unformed, statutory planning defaults to parastatals, so the elected city cannot control its own spatial future.

- □□ **Fiscal accountability:** property tax (Art 243X) ties citizens' payments to service demands; grant dependence orients municipalities upward to the grantor.

- □□ **Executive-representative split:** a strong appointed commissioner plus a weak mayor concentrates accountability in the State cadre, not the ballot.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, State variation and implementation constraints

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Governed-not-self-governed critique: □□ the 74th Amendment gave form without power; parastatals and weak planning committees hollow out elected councils.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT, STATE VARIATION AND IMPLEMENTATION CONSTRAINTS: RECALL MAP

5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, State variation and implementation constraints

V

Dimension 1 Governed-not-self-governed critique: □□ the 74th Amendment gave form without power; parastatals and weak planning committees hollow out elected counci	**Dimension 2** Counter (real structure exists): □□ regular SEC-run elections, reservation, and the Twelfth Schedule provide a genuine framework that empowered States
Dimension 3 State variation: □□ some States constitute and fund DPC/MPC and devolve more subjects; others delay elections, leave MPCs unformed, or route missions	**Dimension 4** Implementation constraints: □□ incomplete activity mapping, absent MPCs, delayed SFCs, low property-tax effort, dependence on tied grants, and parasta

STATIC THEORY

- **Counter (real structure exists):** □□ regular SEC-run elections, reservation, and the Twelfth Schedule provide a genuine framework that empowered States can use.

- **State variation:** □□ some States constitute and fund DPC/MPC and devolve more subjects; others delay elections, leave MPCs unformed, or route missions through SPVs — empowerment is **uneven and State-dependent**.

- **Implementation constraints:** □□ incomplete activity mapping, absent MPCs, delayed SFCs, low property-tax effort, dependence on tied grants, and parastatal capture of core functions.

- **Fact-safety on numbers:** □ do **not** state a municipal own-revenue percentage, a share of GDP or a devolution rank without a named official source and year.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, State variation and implementation constraints

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Empowerment verdict: "The 74th Amendment constitutionalised urban local bodies but left their functional and financial empowerment optional, so India's cities have representation without full self-government."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.10 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Empowerment verdict: "The 74th Amendment constitutionalised urban local bodies but left their functional and financial empowerment optional, so India'	**Dimension 2** Planning verdict: "The Metropolitan and District Planning Committees are the amendment's decisive institutions and its greatest failure; until they ar
Dimension 3 Finance verdict: "Municipal fiscal weakness is a problem of effort and machinery, not of constitutional power — Art 243X already permits the taxes and	

STATIC THEORY

- **Planning verdict:** "The Metropolitan and District Planning Committees are the amendment's decisive institutions and its greatest failure; until they are constituted and empowered, development authorities will plan cities that elect their own councils."

- **Finance verdict:** "Municipal fiscal weakness is a problem of effort and machinery, not of constitutional power — Art 243X already permits the taxes and funds that under-collection and SFC delay leave unused."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Eleventh vs Twelfth Schedule	**Twelfth = 18** subjects for **municipalities** (Art 243W); Eleventh = 29 for panchayats
Three types by size	Nagar Panchayat (**transitional**) less than Municipal Council (**smaller urban**) less than Municipal Corporation (**larger urban**)
Nagar Panchayat	An **urban** body for a transitional area — **not** a village panchayat
Wards Committees	Mandatory only where population **≥ 3 lakh** (Art 243S) — not in every municipality
DPC vs MPC composition	**DPC = 4/5 elected** (Art 243ZD); **MPC = 2/3 elected** (Art 243ZE) — do not swap
Who runs municipal polls	**State Election Commission (Art 243ZA)** — not the ECI
Cantonment Board	Set up by the **Centre** under the **Defence Ministry** (Cantonments Act) — not a State ULB
Notified Area Committee	**Fully nominated** — hence not a democratic elected body

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Industrial township	The Governor may specify it and **no municipality need be constituted** (Art 243Q proviso)
Enacted vs in force	74th Amendment **passed 1992**, **in force 1 June 1993**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 Part IX-A = **Art 243-P to 243-ZG**; Twelfth Schedule = **18** subjects under **Art 243W**. Article map: three types **243Q**, composition **243R**, Wards Committees **243S**, reservation **243T**, duration **243U**, disqualification **243V**, taxation/funds **243X**, Finance Commission **243Y**, State Election Commission **243ZA**, DPC **243ZD**, MPC **243ZE**, bar on court interference **243ZG**. Commencement **1 June 1993**; candidate age **21**; term **five years**; Wards Committees threshold **≥ 3 lakh**.

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Art 243W/243X are **enabling ("may")** — do not assert automatic devolution of the 18 subjects or of taxes.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 Art 243W/243X are enabling ("may") — do not assert automatic devolution of the 18 subjects or of taxes.	**Dimension 2** On municipal own-revenue shares, property-tax collection efficiency and devolution rankings, do not quote a figure without a named, dated official s
Dimension 3 Urban missions and their status: JNNURM (2005, concluded), AMRUT (2015), AMRUT 2.0 (2021), Smart Cities Mission (2015, SPV-led) — verify a mission's	**Dimension 4** Mayoral tenure and the directly-elected-mayor model vary by State — do not state a single national rule or attribute a current model to a State wit

STATIC THEORY

- On municipal own-revenue shares, property-tax collection efficiency and devolution rankings, **do not quote a figure** without a named, dated official source; use qualitative evidence (parastatal capture, unformed MPCs, SFC delays).

- Urban missions and their status: **JNNURM (2005, concluded)**, **AMRUT (2015)**, **AMRUT 2.0 (2021)**, **Smart Cities Mission (2015, SPV-led)** — verify a mission's current phase before dating it; a mission is a scheme, not a constitutional devolution of the 18 subjects.

- Mayoral tenure and the directly-elected-mayor model **vary by State** — do not state a single national rule or attribute a current model to a State without checking its present status.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Constitutional precision and current controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 Article 243R: experts may be represented but cannot vote in municipal meetings; State law may represent specified MPs/MLAs, registered Rajya Sabha/Legislative Council members and committee chairpersons, while State law determines the chairperson's election. **Article 243T:** SC/ST seat reservation is population-linked; at least one-third of total seats, including SC/ST seats, are for women. State law prescribes SC/ST and women chairperson reservations; backward-class reservation is enabling. **Article 243U:** a municipality gets a reasonable opportunity before dissolution; election follows before expiry or within six months after dissolution, except when the remainder is below six months; an early reconstituted body serves only the balance.

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Articles 243ZB/ZC/ZF: the President may adapt Part IXA for Union Territories; Scheduled and tribal areas are excluded and Parliament may extend it to Scheduled Areas; inconsistent old municipal laws continued for at most one year, while existing municipalities continued to term unless lawfully dissolved.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CONSTITUTIONAL PRECISION AND CURRENT CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

Constitutional precision and current controls

V

Dimension 1 Articles 243ZB/ZC/ZF: the President may adapt Part IXA for Union Territories; Scheduled and tribal areas are excluded and Parliament may extend it t	**Dimension 2** DPC/MPC: DPC has at least four-fifths elected from district-Panchayat and municipal elected members in the rural:urban population ratio; MPC has at
Dimension 3 Judgments: Kishansing Tomar (2006) protects timely local elections; K. Krishna Murthy (2010) and Vikas Kishanrao Gawali (2021) control backward-cla	**Dimension 4** Dated controls, checked 5 September 2026: RBI's Report on Municipal Finances (2022), Sixteenth Finance Commission report/action memorandum for 2026–

STATIC THEORY

- **DPC/MPC:** DPC has at least four-fifths elected from district-Panchayat and municipal elected members in the rural:urban population ratio; MPC has at least two-thirds elected from municipal elected members and Panchayat chairpersons in the municipality:Panchayat population ratio. Both prepare a draft plan which the chair forwards to the State Government.

- **Judgments:** *Kishansing Tomar* (2006) protects timely local elections; *K. Krishna Murthy* (2010) and *Vikas Kishanrao Gawali* (2021) control backward-class political reservation; *Fouziya Imtiaz Shaikh* (2021) protects SEC independence.

- **Dated controls, checked 5 September 2026:** RBI's *Report on Municipal Finances* (2022), Sixteenth Finance Commission report/action memorandum for 2026–31, AMRUT 2.0 guidelines/toolkit, and SEBI's municipal-debt framework/current statistics. Treat dashboard and issuance totals as dated, not permanent.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Articles 243ZB/ZC/ZF: the President may adapt Part IXA for Union Territories; Scheduled and tribal areas are excluded and Parliament may extend it to Scheduled Areas; inconsistent old municipal laws continued for at most one year, while existing municipalities continued to term unless lawfully dissolved.

2. DPC/MPC: DPC has at least four-fifths elected from district-Panchayat and municipal elected members in the rural:urban population ratio; MPC has at least two-thirds elected from municipal elected members and Panchayat chairpersons in the municipality:Panchayat population ratio. Both prepare a draft plan which the chair forwards to the State Government.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Constitutional precision and current controls

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Constitutional birth: *the Constitution (Seventy-fourth Amendment) Act, 1992 inserted Part IXA and the Twelfth Schedule and commenced on 1 June 1993. Articles 243P-243ZG and the eighteen Schedule matters are the exact core.* ***Municipal types:*** *Article 243Q distinguishes Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council and Municipal Corporation and contains the industrial-township proviso. State notification and State law determine the actual institutional form.* ***Democratic design:*** *Articles 243R-243V govern composition, Ward Committees, reservation, five-year duration and disqualification. Article 243S requires Ward Committees at population three lakh or more; Article 243T fixes the constitutional one-third women's floor and population-linked SC/ST reservation.* ***Election and continuity:*** *Article 243U uses the same before-expiry/within-six months rule and unexpired-term principle; Article 243ZA assigns elections to the State Election Commission and Article 243ZG bars ordinary electoral interference.* ***Functional and fiscal limit:*** *Article 243W and the Twelfth Schedule are enabling rather than self-executing. Article 243X permits State-law taxes, assignments, grants and funds; Article 243Y uses the Article 243I State Finance Commission. Constitutional existence is not automatic three-F devolution.* ***Planning precision:*** *Article 243ZD requires at least four-fifths elected representation on a District Planning Committee; Article 243ZE requires at least two-thirds on a Metropolitan Planning Committee. A metropolitan area is ten lakh or more under Article 243P(c); planning committees do not themselves control every parastatal, budget or land power.* ***Scope controls:*** *Articles 243ZB/ZC apply/adapt Part IXA to Union Territories and exclude Scheduled/tribal areas subject to the constitutional extension route; Article 243ZF governed transition and Article 243ZG the election bar.* ***Current finance:*** *the Sixteenth Finance Commission covers 2026-27 to 2030-31 and recommends a 60:40 rural-urban aggregate split, with basic and performance components; these are dated grant recommendations, not permanent constitutional ratios.* ***Current regulation:*** *AMRUT 2.0 remains a scheme/reform framework rather than constitutional devolution. The SEBI (Issue and Listing of Municipal Debt Securities) Regulations, 2015 were amended on 8 July 2026, followed by the 11 August 2026 implementation circular; municipal bonds remain debt, not own tax.* ***Four-ledger/PYQ control:*** *direct 2023 functional-financial empowerment and routed 2024 rural-urban merger demands were retained. Topic 23 owns rural institutions; Topic 26 owns excluded Scheduled/tribal-area architecture.*

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 39 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Municipalities.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 39 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

- *Companion: basic/Municipalities.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — 74th AMENDMENT ACT, 1992 □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Added **Part IX-A ("The Municipalities", Art 243-P to 243-ZG)** + the **Twelfth Schedule (18 functional items, Art 243-W)**. Gave **constitutional status** to urban local bodies (ULBs); came into force **1 June 1993**. State governments are under **constitutional obligation** to adopt the new system.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Added **Part IX-A ("The Municipalities", Art 243-P to 243-ZG)** + the **Twelfth Schedule (18 functional items, Art 243-W)**. Gave **constitutional status** to urban local bodies (ULBs); came into force **1 June 1993**. State governments are under **constitutional obligation** to adopt the new system.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — 74th AMENDMENT ACT, 1992 □

HIGH

Advanced · Three types of municipalities □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Body	For
□ **Nagar Panchayat**	A **transitional area** (rural → urban)
□ **Municipal Council**	A **smaller urban area**
□ **Municipal Corporation**	A **larger urban area**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Three types of municipalities □

HIGH

Advanced · Three types of municipalities □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Exception — Industrial Township:** where an industrial establishment provides municipal services, the Governor may specify it and **no municipality need be constituted**. Governor classifies areas on **population, density, revenue, % non-agricultural employment, economic importance**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Exception — Industrial Township: where an industrial establishment provides municipal services, the Governor may specify it and **no municipality need be constituted**. Governor classifies areas on **population, density, revenue, % non-agricultural employment, economic importance**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Three types of municipalities □

HIGH

Advanced · Salient features

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Feature	Detail
□ **Composition**	All **territorial seats** directly elected from wards; Art 243-R permits specified additional representation
□ **Wards Committees**	Mandatory in municipalities with population **≥ 3 lakh**
□ **Reservation**	SC/ST by population + **≥ 1/3 seats for women**; BC reservation optional
□ **Duration**	**5-year term**; election within **6 months** of dissolution; reasonable opportunity of hearing before dissolution
□ **Disqualification**	Age **21** allowed (vs 25 for state legislature)
□ **State Election Commission**	Conducts municipal polls
□ **Finances**	Same **State Finance Commission** (as for panchayats) reviews ULB finances every 5 years

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Salient features

HIGH

Advanced · Exempted areas □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Does **NOT** apply to Fifth/Sixth Schedule (scheduled & tribal) areas, and does not affect the **Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Does **NOT** apply to Fifth/Sixth Schedule (scheduled & tribal) areas, and does not affect the **Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Exempted areas □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — PLANNING COMMITTEES □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Committee	Level	Membership rule
□ **District Planning Committee (DPC)**	Every **district** — consolidates panchayat + municipality plans	**4/5 elected** by elected members of district panchayat + municipalities (in rural:urban ratio)
□ **Metropolitan Planning Committee (MPC)**	Every **metropolitan area**	**2/3 elected** by elected members of municipalities + panchayat chairpersons (in population ratio)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — PLANNING COMMITTEES □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — EIGHT TYPES OF URBAN LOCAL BODIES □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Beyond the constitutional three, India has **8 types** of urban administration: **Municipal Corporation · Municipality · Notified Area Committee · Town Area Committee · Cantonment Board · Township · Port Trust · Special Purpose Agency.**

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — EIGHT TYPES OF URBAN LOCAL BODIES □: RECALL MAP

PART C — EIGHT TYPES OF URBAN LOCAL BODIES □

V

Dimension 1 □ Beyond the constitutional three, India has 8 types of urban administration: Municipal Corporation · Municipality · Notified Area Committee · Town Ar	**Dimension 2** □□ Cantonment Board — set up by the central government (Cantonments Act) under the Defence Ministry.
Dimension 3 □□ Notified Area Committee — for a fast-developing town / one not yet a municipality; fully nominated	**Dimension 4** (hence not a democratic body).

STATIC THEORY

- □□ **Cantonment Board** — set up by the **central government** (Cantonments Act) under the **Defence Ministry**.

- □□ **Notified Area Committee** — for a fast-developing town / one not yet a municipality; **fully nominated**

- (hence not a democratic body).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Beyond the constitutional three, India has **8 types** of urban administration: **Municipal Corporation · Municipality · Notified Area Committee · Town Area Committee · Cantonment Board · Township · Port Trust · Special Purpose Agency.**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — EIGHT TYPES OF URBAN LOCAL BODIES □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Twelfth Schedule has 29 items

CORRECT: 18 items (Eleventh Schedule = 29 for panchayats).

WRONG: 74th Amendment in force 1992

CORRECT: passed 1992, in force 1 June 1993.

WRONG: Wards Committees mandatory in every municipality

CORRECT: only where population **≥ 3 lakh**.

WRONG: Nagar Panchayat = a village panchayat

CORRECT: it is an **urban** body for a **transitional area**.

WRONG: Cantonment Board is a state ULB

CORRECT: set up by the **Centre** (Defence Ministry).

WRONG: Municipal Corporation is the smallest ULB

CORRECT: it is for the **largest** urban areas.

WRONG: DPC has 2/3 elected members

CORRECT: 4/5 (DPC 4/5, MPC 2/3 — don't swap).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ **Municipal finances crisis** — ULBs' own revenue is a tiny share of GDP; property-tax reform & the **16th Finance Commission** grants to urban bodies. □ □□ **Empowerment of Mayors / directly-elected mayor debate** and weak devolution of the 18 subjects

INTRO & ORIGIN

(planning still with parastatals — the "3 Fs" gap in cities).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ □□ **AMRUT 2.0, Smart Cities Mission** vs the constitutional role of elected ULBs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"Indian cities are governed but not self-governed." Examine in light of the 74th Amendment's unfulfilled promise. Parastatals (development authorities, water boards) vs elected municipalities — the crisis of urban governance. Strengthening municipal finances: property tax, municipal bonds, and Finance Commission devolution. less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -->

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	GS-II	3	States empowering urban local bodies functionally and financially	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE
Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2023* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-II* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

States empowering urban local bodies functionally and financially

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 States empowering urban local bodies functionally and financially	**Dimension 2** The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -—›	

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -->

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Advanced · Precision addendum — Part IXA provisos

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Article 243Q's industrial-township proviso covers an urban area or part where an industrial establishment provides or proposes municipal services; it is not an ordinary fourth municipality.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PRECISION ADDENDUM — PART IXA PROVISOS: RECALL MAP

Precision addendum — Part IXA provisos

V

Dimension 1 Article 243Q's industrial-township proviso covers an urban area or part where an industrial establishment provides or proposes municipal services; it	**Dimension 2** Articles 243R/T/U require exact treatment of non-voting experts, chairperson reservation, pre-dissolution hearing, the short-remainder exception and t
Dimension 3 Articles 243ZB/ZC/ZF cover Union-Territory adaptation, excluded Scheduled/tribal areas, parliamentary extension and transition of pre-1993 laws/bodies	**Dimension 4** DPC/MPC elected fractions are floors, not complete composition formulas; both draft plans are forwarded by their chairpersons to the State Government.

STATIC THEORY

- Articles 243R/T/U require exact treatment of non-voting experts, chairperson reservation, pre-dissolution hearing, the short-remainder exception and the unexpired-term rule.

- Articles 243ZB/ZC/ZF cover Union-Territory adaptation, excluded Scheduled/tribal areas, parliamentary extension and transition of pre-1993 laws/bodies.

- DPC/MPC elected fractions are floors, not complete composition formulas; both draft plans are forwarded by their chairpersons to the State Government.

- Cantonment Boards are Union/Defence institutions under central cantonment law, not Article 243Q municipalities; census towns are statistical categories; industrial townships are notified constitutional exceptions.

- Current controls checked 28 August 2026: RBI municipal-finance report (2022), Sixteenth Finance Commission 2026–31 documents, AMRUT 2.0 guidelines/toolkit, and SEBI municipal-debt framework/statistics.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Municipalities — 74th Amendment (Articles 243-P–243-ZG, Part IX-A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Precision addendum — Part IXA provisos

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI